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Battery module

Abstract

A battery module includes a module including a series of cell stacks, each having a series of unit cells arranged in a first direction, and an insulation member insulating at least one unit cell. The battery module also includes a module housing and a series of receiving parts in the module housing accommodating the cell stacks. Each receiving part includes a fixed wall around a respective cell stack and having a portion in contact with the cell stack. The fixed wall includes a pair of end walls at opposite ends of the receiving part in the first direction. The pair of end walls are configured to engage respective end surfaces of the corresponding cell stack in the first direction. The battery module also includes a cooling channel below a floor surface of the module housing for a coolant to flow to cool the receiving parts and the cells stacks.

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Background/Summary

CROSS-REFERENCE TO RELATED APPLICATIONS (1) This application is a continuation of U.S. patent application Ser. No. 16/655,889, filed Oct. 17, 2019, which claims priority to and the benefit of Korean Patent Application No. 10-2018-0125551 filed in the Korean Intellectual Property Office on Oct. 19, 2018, the entire contents of which are incorporated herein by reference, and incorporates, in their entirety, by reference U.S. patent application Ser. No. 16/656,197, U.S. patent application Ser. No. 16/656,324, U.S. patent application Ser. No. 16/656,190, U.S. patent application Ser. No. 16/656,406, and U.S. patent application Ser. No. 16/656,099, all filed on Oct. 17, 2019.

BACKGROUND

(a) Field

(1) The present disclosure relates to a battery module, and to a battery module including a plurality of cell stacks formed of a plurality of unit cells.

(b) Description of the Related Art

(2) A rechargeable or secondary battery is different from a primary battery in that charge and discharge are repeatable, and the primary battery provides only irreversible conversion from a chemical material to electric energy. A low-capacity rechargeable battery may be used as a power source of a small electronic device, such as a mobile phone, a notebook computer, a computer, and a camcorder, and a large-capacity rechargeable battery may be used as a power source of a hybrid vehicle and the like.

(3) The secondary battery may include a positive electrode, a negative electrode, an electrode assembly including a separator interposed between the positive electrode and the negative electrode, a case accommodating the electrode assembly, and an electrode terminal electrically connected with the electrode assembly.

(4) An electrolyte solution is injected into the case so as to enable a battery to be chargeable and rechargeable by an electrochemical reaction of the positive electrode, the negative electrode, and the electrolyte solution. For example, a shape of the case may be a cylindrical shape or a rectangular shape, which may be different depending on the use of the battery.

(5) The rechargeable battery may be used in the form of a cell stack including a plurality of unit cells which are coupled in series with, or in parallel to, each other, thereby providing high energy density for driving of a hybrid vehicle, for example.

(6) Additionally, with the development of technology, an amount of electric power required for an electric vehicle (EV), a hybrid electric vehicle (HEV) and other electrical energy consuming

devices is increased, and a plurality of battery modules may be provided to satisfy the amount of electric power.

(7) Therefore, the development of a new module structure that may simplify the components, effectively reduce the manufacturing cost and weight, and enable the manufacturing process to proceed efficiently while providing a plurality of cell stacks capable of meeting the required power of the electrical energy consuming device is an important task.

(8) The above information disclosed in this Background section is only for enhancement of understanding of the background of the invention and therefore it may contain information that does not form the prior art that is already known in this country to a person of ordinary skill in the art.

SUMMARY

(9) The present invention has been made in an effort to provide a large module of a battery having advantages of effectively improving an amount of electric power, and efficiently improving the manufacturing process while simplifying components by including a plurality of cell stacks. A battery module according to an exemplary embodiment of the present invention includes at least one module including a series of cell stacks, each cell stack of the series of cell stacks including a series of unit cells arranged in a first direction and an insulation member insulating at least one unit cell of the series of unit cells. The battery module also includes a module housing and a series of receiving parts in the module housing configured to accommodate the series of cell stacks. Each receiving part of the series of receiving parts includes a fixed wall around a corresponding cell stack of the series of cell stacks, the fixed wall including a pair of end walls at opposite ends of the receiving part in the first direction. The pair of end walls are configured to engage respective end surfaces of the corresponding cell stack in the first direction. A cooling channel for a coolant to flow to cool the series of receiving parts and the series of cell stacks is below a floor surface of the module housing.

(10) A cooling plate may be coupled to the floor surface of the module housing, and the cooling channel may be defined in the cooling plate.

(11) The module housing may include at least one lateral wall protruding downward and surrounding the floor surface. The at least one lateral wall may define the cooling channel. The at least one module may further include a channel cover coupled to lower ends of the at least one lateral wall to close and seal the cooling channel.

(12) The at least one lateral wall of the module housing may be integral with the floor surface.

(13) The at least one module may include a first module and a second module adjacent to the first module and coupled to the first module.

(14) The battery module may further include a coupling part coupling the module housing of the first module to the module housing of the second module, and a coolant line connected to the cooling channel of the module housing of each of the first and second modules.

(15) The module housing of the first module may be coupled to the module housing of the second module in a second direction perpendicular to the first direction, and the coolant line may extend in the second direction and include a series of port connection holes spaced apart from each other along a length direction of the coolant line and coupled to the cooling channel of each of the first and second modules.

(16) The coupling part may include a first coupling part in a first wall of the module housing of the first module and a second coupling part in a second wall of the module housing of the second module. The first wall is spaced apart from the second wall in the second direction.

(17) The coolant line may include an inflow line configured to supply coolant to the cooling channel and an outflow line through which the coolant is discharged from the cooling channel. The inflow line is connected to one side of the cooling channel of each of the first and second modules, the outflow line is connected to the other side of the cooling channel of each of the first and second modules, and the one side and the other side of the cooling channel are at opposite sides along the

first direction.

(18) At least one of the series of port connection holes may have a different diameter than at least one other port connection hole of the series of port connection holes.

(19) The module housing may further include a separation wall that extends in the first direction and partitions an inner space surrounded by an outer wall of the module housing to form the plurality of receiving parts. The separation wall may define a part of the fixed wall of each of the series of receiving parts at sides along a second direction that is perpendicular to the first direction. The separation wall may contact side surfaces of a pair of cell stacks of the series of cell stacks in respective receiving parts of the series of receiving parts.

(20) An end wall of the pair of end walls facing the outer wall of the module housing may be spaced apart from the outer wall along the first direction and may define a first impact absorption space between the end wall and the outer wall.

(21) The series of receiving parts may include two receiving parts adjacent to each other along the first direction, and end walls of the two receiving parts facing each other in the first direction may be spaced apart from each other to define a second impact absorption space between the end walls.

(22) Each cell stack of the series of cell stacks may further include a pair of end supports at opposite end portions in the first direction, and the pair of end supports may have outer surfaces corresponding to the end surfaces.

(23) The end walls may be bent outwardly such that central portions of the end walls are spaced away from the end surfaces, and the end surfaces may be recessed inwardly such that central portions of the end surfaces are spaced away from the end walls.

(24) At least one end wall of the end walls may include a series of first ribs protruding in the first direction from an outer surface. The plurality of first ribs may be spaced apart from each other in the second direction and may extend in a third direction perpendicular to each of the first and second directions.

(25) At least one end support of the pair of end supports may include a series of second ribs protruding toward the at least one end wall from the end surface and may be spaced apart from each other in the second direction and the third direction.

(26) The series of second ribs may have a lattice structure.

(27) According to an embodiment of the present invention, by including a plurality of cell stacks, the amount of electric power may be effectively improved, and the manufacturing process may be efficiently improved while simplifying the components.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

(1) FIG. 1 is a view illustrating a battery module according to an exemplary embodiment of the present invention.

(2) FIG. 2 is a view illustrating a receiving part in the battery module battery according to an exemplary embodiment of the present invention.

(3) FIG. 3 is a view schematically illustrating a cooling channel in the battery module according to an exemplary embodiment of the present invention.

(4) FIG. 4 is a view of the cooling channel in the battery module according to an exemplary embodiment of the present invention when being viewed from below.

(5) FIG. 5 is a view illustrating a figure in which battery modules according to an exemplary embodiment of the present invention are coupled to each other.

(6) FIG. 6 shows that a battery module according to the exemplary embodiment of the present invention is connected in plural and coolant lines are coupled.

(7) FIG. 7 shows that a port connection hole of the coolant line is coupled to a cooling channel in

the battery module according to the exemplary embodiment of the present invention.

(8) FIG. 8 shows a connection port to which the port connection hole is coupled in the battery module according to the exemplary embodiment of the present invention.

(9) FIG. 9 is a view illustrating an end wall and an end support in the battery module according to an exemplary embodiment of the present invention.

(10) FIG. 10 is a view illustrating a shape of the end wall in the battery module according to an exemplary embodiment of the present invention.

(11) FIG. 11 is a view illustrating an end surface of the end support in the battery module according to an exemplary embodiment of the present invention.

(12) FIG. 12 is a view illustrating a figure in which battery modules according to another exemplary embodiment of the present invention are coupled to each other.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION

(13) In the following detailed description, only certain exemplary embodiments of the present invention have been shown and described, simply by way of illustration.

(14) As those skilled in the art would realize, the described embodiments may be modified in various different ways, all without departing from the spirit or scope of the present invention. Accordingly, the drawings and description are to be regarded as illustrative in nature and not restrictive. Like reference numerals designate like elements throughout the specification.

(15) In the present specification, an overlapped description for the same components will be omitted.

(16) Further, in the present specification, it is to be understood that when one component is referred to as being 'connected to' another component, it may be connected directly to another component or be connected to another component with the other component interposed therebetween. On the other hand, in the present specification, it is to be understood that when one component is referred to as being 'directly connected to' another component, it may be connected to another component without the other component interposed therebetween.

(17) In addition, terms used in the present specification are used only in order to describe specific exemplary embodiments rather than limiting the present invention.

(18) Further, in the present specification, singular forms are intended to include plural forms unless the context clearly indicates otherwise.

(19) It should be further understood that terms "include" or "have" used in the present specification specify the presence of features, numerals, steps, operations, components, parts mentioned in the present specification, or combinations thereof, but do not preclude the presence or addition of one or more other features, numerals, steps, operations, components, parts, or combinations thereof.

(20) Further, in the present specification, a term 'and/or' includes a combination of a plurality of stated items or any one of the plurality of stated items. In the present specification, 'A or B' may include 'A', 'B', or 'both of A and B'.

(21) FIG. 1 illustrates a battery module **1000** according to an exemplary embodiment of the present invention and FIG. 2 illustrates a view illustrating a receiving part **220** illustrated in FIG. 1.

(22) As illustrated in FIGS. 1 and 2, the battery module **1000** according to an exemplary embodiment of the present invention includes a cell stack **100** in which a plurality of unit cells **110** are aligned in a first direction X and including an insulation member **112** around (or surrounding) the plurality of unit cells **110**, and a module housing **200** in which a plurality of receiving parts **220** into which the cell stack **100** is inserted are provided, wherein the receiving part **220** includes a fixed wall **250** around (or surrounding) the cell stack **100** and having at least a portion which is in contact with the cell stack **100**.

(23) The cell stack **100** includes the plurality of unit cells **110** aligned in the first direction X. The unit cell **100** may include an electrode assembly, correspond to one secondary battery including a terminal part, and include a case of various shapes such as a rectangular shape, a cylindrical shape, or the like.

(24) FIGS. **1** and **2** illustrates the unit cell **110** having a case having a rectangular pillar shape, but the unit cell **110** is not necessarily limited thereto, and the unit cell **110** having the case of the rectangular shape illustrated in FIGS. **1** and **2** will hereinafter be described for convenience of explanation.

(25) The plurality of unit cells **110** are aligned in the cell stack **100**, and an alignment direction of the unit cells **110** may be various, but the unit cells **110** may be preferably aligned in a direction in which wide side surfaces of side surfaces of the unit cells **110** face each other, as illustrated in FIGS. **1** and **2**. The alignment direction of the unit cells **110** will hereinafter be defined as the first direction X. The unit cells **110** may be disposed or the end supports **120** may be disposed at both ends of the cell stack **100** in the first direction X.

(26) The number of unit cells **110** configuring the cell stack **100** may be various as necessary. The unit cells **110** included in one cell stack **100** may be electrically connected with each other by using a bus bar, which can be provided in various shapes, and the like.

(27) In the meantime, the cell stack **100** includes the insulation member **112** around (or surrounding) the plurality of unit cells **110**. The insulation member **112** is formed of an insulating material, such as rubber and plastic, and surrounds the plurality of unit cells **110**.

(28) In one or more embodiments, the insulation member **112** may also be provided so as to surround end supports **120** disposed at both ends of the cell stack **100** in the first direction X together with the plurality of unit cells **110**, and may surround only the plurality of unit cells **110**, except for the end supports **120**, and the end supports **120** may also be separately disposed at both ends of the cell stack **100**.

(29) The insulation member **112** may be provided in the form of a film, or a plurality of configurations shaped like a plate having hardness may be provided in the insulation member **112**. The insulation member **112** may be provided in the form around (or surrounding) all of the four lateral surfaces of the cell stack **100** or may be disposed at some of the four lateral surfaces, and may also be provided so as to surround both an upper surface and a lower surface of the cell stack **100**. However, the insulation member **112** disposed on the upper surface of the cell stack **100** may be provided so as to expose the terminal unit of each unit cell **110**.

(30) FIG. **1** illustrates the state where the insulation member **112** is prepared in the form of an insulation film to surround the lateral surfaces of the plurality of unit cells **110**, except for the end supports **120**, in the cell stack **100** according to one exemplary embodiment of the present invention.

(31) In the module housing **200**, a plurality of receiving parts **220**, into and/or onto which the cell stacks **100** are inserted, is provided. FIG. **1** illustrates the state where four receiving parts **220** are formed in the module housing **200**, and in FIG. **2**, two receiving parts **220** are separately illustrated in the module housing **200** illustrated in FIG. **1**. The number of receiving parts **220** provided in the module housing **200** may be changed as desired.

(32) In the module housing **200**, an outer wall **210**, which protrudes from a floor surface **260** in an upper direction and surrounds the floor surface **260**, is present, and an internal space is formed at an inner side of the outer wall **210**. The plurality of receiving parts **220** may be provided in the internal space.

(33) A shape of the module housing **200** may be various, and the module housing **200** according to one exemplary embodiment of the present invention may be provided so as to have the floor surface **260** having an approximately quadrangular shape as illustrated in FIGS. **1** and **2**.

(34) The module housing **200** may be provided in the form in which an upper portion of the module housing **200** is opened, and thus, the receiving part **220** provided in the module housing **200** may also be provided in the form in which an upper portion of the receiving part **220** is opened. A module cover may be coupled to the opened upper surface of the module housing **200**, so that the module housing **200** may be sealed, and when the module cover is coupled with the module housing **200**, the module cover corresponds to the upper surface of the receiving part **220**. The

module cover may include a bus bar holder for covering the cell stack **100**, and bus bars arranged in the bus bar holder to electrically connect the unit cells **110** constituting the cell stack **100**.

(35) Additionally, FIGS. **1** and **2** illustrate the receiving part **220** according to one exemplary embodiment of the present invention. The receiving part **220** includes the fixed wall **250** which surrounds the cell stack **100** and of which at least a part is in contact with the cell stack **100**.

(36) FIG. **1** illustrates the state where the portion of the receiving part **220** into which the cell stack **100** is inserted, and the portion of the receiving part **220** into which the cell stack **100** is not inserted, are disposed in parallel. The fixed wall **250** corresponds to a boundary wall around (or surrounding) an area of the receiving part **220**, and the cell stack **100** inserted into the receiving part **220** stably maintains a fixed state surrounded by the fixed wall **250** in four directions.

(37) The fixed wall **250** may be variously disposed according to the form of the cell stack **100**, but as illustrated in FIG. **1**, the fixed wall **250** may have four surfaces, which support four-directional lateral surfaces of the cell stack **100** while facing the four-directional lateral surfaces, respectively, and be disposed so as to surround the cell stack **100**.

(38) At least a part of the fixed wall **250** of the receiving part **220** is in direct contact with the cell stack **100**. For example, any one surface of the fixed wall **250** positioned in the first direction X may also be in direct contact with the cell stack **100**, and any one surface of the fixed wall **250** positioned in a second direction Y perpendicular to the first direction X may also be in direct contact with the lateral surfaces of the plurality of unit cells **110**, for example, the insulation member **112**.

(39) The second direction Y may be defined as a direction perpendicular to the first direction X on the same plane as that of the first direction X, and may be defined as a width direction of the unit cell **110** as illustrated in FIG. **1**.

(40) As described above, in one exemplary embodiment of the present invention, the cell stack **100** may maintain the shape by the fixed wall **250** even without a separate component, and may maintain a state pressed in the first direction X.

(41) In a case of a related art general battery module, not the battery module **1000** of the present disclosure, a module frame is coupled to one cell stack and one cell stack, which is coupled with the module frame and is treated as a unit configuration, forms one module.

(42) The generally treated cell stack may be coupled with a module frame for a performance aspect, such as energy density, and treatment easiness, and the module frame may be formed of end blocks pressing both ends of the cell stack, side plates extended alongside surfaces of the cell stack, and the like, and the end blocks and the side plates may be coupled with each other in the state where the cell stack is pressed to maintain the structure of the cell stack.

(43) In a related art general battery module, the cell stack coupled with the module frame is inserted and the module housing is fastened to the module frame, and the general battery module becomes a battery module having the power amount provided by one cell stack.

(44) In the case of the related art general battery module, a plurality of battery modules needs to be provided so as to meet higher power demanded than that of one cell stack, and thus, a module frame fastening the cell units into a unit body and a plurality of components configuring a module itself are additionally required.

(45) Therefore, in the related art, a process for manufacturing the battery module may be increased, the consumption for the components may be increased, a weight of the battery module may be increased, and the time and cost required for manufacturing the battery module may be increased.

(46) However, in the battery module **1000** according to one exemplary embodiment of the present invention, the plurality of cell stacks **100** is mounted to one module, unlike the related art general battery module, which is thus advantageous to meet the high power demanded, and the cell stack **100** is fixed by the fixed wall **250** of the receiving part **220**, of which at least a part is separate from the outer wall **210** of the module housing **200**, so that a component, such as a module frame, for fixing the cell stack **100**, is not separately required.

(47) That is, as shown in FIG. 1 and FIG. 2, in one exemplary embodiment of the present disclosure, a plurality of receiving parts **220** exists in one module housing **200**, and the fixed wall **250** around the receiving part **220** is provided to fix each cell stack **100** while surrounding the same, unlike the outer wall **210** of the module housing **200**.

(48) Additionally, as shown in FIG. 1 to FIG. 2, the module housing **200** according to one exemplary embodiment of the present disclosure may further include end walls **240** that extend in the second direction Y and may be disposed at both ends of each of the plurality of receiving parts **220** in the first direction X to each engage (e.g., press or pressurize) the end surfaces of both sides of the cell stack **100**, and the end wall **240** may correspond to a part of the fixed wall **250**.

(49) In one exemplary embodiment, the side surfaces of both ends of the cell stack **100** in the first direction X are defined as the end surfaces, respectively. According to one exemplary embodiment of the present disclosure, the end surface may correspond to the insulation member **112** or one surface of the end support **120**.

(50) FIGS. 1 and 2 illustrate a figure in which the end walls **240** are disposed at both sides of the cell stack **100** in the first direction X. A plurality of end walls **240** may exist in the module housing **200** and may correspond to both sides of the fixed wall **250** of the receiving part **220** in the first direction X.

(51) The end wall **240** may be distinguished from the outer wall **210** of the module housing **200**. For example, the end wall **240** has a shape protruding from the floor surface **260** in the inner space of the module housing **200** and extends in the second direction Y, and a plurality of end walls **240** may be disposed so as to be spaced apart from the outer wall **210** facing one surface or the other end wall **240** facing each other.

(52) FIG. 1 illustrates a figure in which a plurality of receiving parts **220**, for example a total of four receiving parts **220** are provided with two in the first direction X and two in the second direction Y, and one separation wall **230** that crosses a portion of the inner space of the module housing **200** in the first direction X and four end walls **240** extending in the second direction Y are provided.

(53) The separation wall **230** is shared by the receiving parts **220** disposed at both sides in the second direction Y, and the end walls **240** are not shared at both sides in the length direction and the respective end walls **240** are disposed to be spaced apart from each other (e.g., by a gap) and with surfaces of the two receiving parts **220** facing each other in the first direction X.

(54) That is, the end wall **240** may be disposed in a way that one side of the end wall **240** contacts the end surface of the cell stack **100** that is inserted into the corresponding receiving part **220** and the other side thereof is disposed apart from an outer wall **210** that faces thereto or an end wall **240** of another receiving part **220** that is disposed in parallel in the first direction X.

(55) At least a part of each of the pair of end walls **240** disposed at both sides of the receiving part **220** in the first direction X is in direct contact with the facing end surface of the cell stack **100**, for example, one surface of the end support **120**. Further, the end wall **240** may be disposed to press the cell stack **100** in the first direction X.

(56) As described above, in one exemplary embodiment of the present disclosure, the cell stack **100** inserted into the receiving part **220** is not fastened with a module frame, such as an end block or a side plate, but is provided in the form of which the lateral surfaces may be surrounded by the insulation member **112** in the state where the plurality of unit cells **110** is simply arranged, and in the battery module **1000**, the end wall **240** may serve to press and fix the cell stack **100** in the first direction X.

(57) The cell stack **100** is pressed in the first direction X to provide higher power under the same volume, and may be maintained in a structurally stable state.

(58) The cell stack **100** may be inserted between the fixed walls **250** of the receiving part **220**, such as between the pair of end walls **240** provided at both sides in the first direction X in the state of pressing the end surfaces and being pressed through a zig inserted into the receiving part **220**, and

may maintain a pressed state by the pair of end walls **240**.

(59) FIG. **3** illustrates a cross section of the module housing **200** according to an exemplary embodiment of the present invention, and illustrates a figure in which a cooling channel **300** having a flowing space **310** in which a coolant flows is formed below the floor surface **260**. FIG. **4** illustrates a bottom view of the cooling channel **300**.

(60) As shown in FIG. **3**, in the battery module **1000** according to an exemplary embodiment of the present disclosure, the cooling channel **300** through which the coolant (e.g., coolant water) flows may be formed below the floor surface **260** of the module housing **200**. In addition, a plurality of guide protrusions **350** extending in a flow direction of the coolant and guiding the flow of the coolant may be provided on a lower surface of the floor surface **260** as illustrated in FIG. **4**.

(61) The flowing space **310** of the cooling channel **300** may be formed across the entirety of the floor surface **260**, or may also be formed to correspond to a cross sectional area of the inner space of the module housing **200** in which the receiving parts **220** are formed. For example, in one or more embodiments, the flowing space **310** of the cooling channel **300** may not exist below the first impact absorbing space **215**. The coolant flows through the cooling channel **300**, and various refrigerants such as air instead of the coolant may also be used.

(62) The unit cells **110** constituting the cell stack **100** correspond to heating elements that dissipate heat during discharge, and in a case in which the temperature of the unit cells rises excessively, swelling may be induced or a thermal runaway phenomenon may occur where heat is rapidly increased due to abrupt chemical reaction and fire or the like occurs.

(63) In addition, in a case in which the cell stack **100** in which the plurality of unit cells **110** are aligned is used as in an exemplary embodiment of the present disclosure, when the thermal runaway phenomenon occurs in any one of the unit cells **110**, a thermal runaway diffusion phenomenon, which affects other peripheral unit cells **110**, may also occur.

(64) As described above, when the plurality of unit cells **110** are disposed, it is important to adequately cool the heat generated in the cell stack **100**, and accordingly, the battery module **1000** according to an exemplary embodiment of the present disclosure efficiently implements the cooling of the entirety of the plurality of cell stacks **100** by forming the cooling channel **300** below the bottom surface **260** of the module housing **200**.

(65) In addition, in an exemplary embodiment of the present disclosure, the maintenance and management of the cooling channel **300** may be more easily performed by forming the cooling channel **300** below the bottom surface **260** of the module housing **200** rather than the inside of the module housing **200**, that is, the inner space and the partitioned space of the module housing **200**. For example, in an exemplary embodiment of the present disclosure, even when a module cover of the module housing **200** is assembled, the maintenance and management of the cooling channel **300** from a lower portion of the module housing **200** can be performed.

(66) Additionally, in the battery module **1000** according to the exemplary embodiment of the present disclosure, the lateral wall **320** of the cooling channel **300** protrudes from the floor surface **260** in the down direction, is extended along a border of the floor surface **260** and is formed to surround the floor surface **260**, and the channel cover **330** is coupled to a lower end of the lateral wall **320** to seal the cooling channel **300**.

(67) Further, the lateral wall **320** of the cooling channel **300** may be integrally formed with the floor surface **260** of the module housing **200** through a casting process, and the channel cover **330** may be welded and coupled to the lateral wall **320** of the cooling channel **300**.

(68) FIG. **3** illustrates the state where the lateral wall **320** of the cooling channel **300** extends along the border of the floor surface **260** of the module housing **200** to surround the floor surface **260**, and protrudes from the floor surface **260** in the down direction.

(69) In the exemplary embodiment of the present disclosure, the lateral wall **320** of the cooling channel **300** is integrally formed with the floor surface **260** of the module housing **200** through the cast process, so that a coupling region between the lateral wall **320** and the floor surface **260** does

not exist, and thus, it is possible to prevent the coolant from unintentionally leaking into the module housing **200**.

(70) The channel cover **330** sealing the cooling channel **300** may be coupled to the lateral wall **320** of the cooling channel **300** by a method, such as welding, and a border of the channel cover **330** may be coupled to the lower end of the lateral wall **320**.

(71) The coupling method may be various, but a gasket may be provided or welded for preventing leakage of the coolant, and FIG. **13** illustrates the cooling channel **300** viewed from the bottom side in the state where the channel cover **330** is removed.

(72) In an exemplary embodiment of the present disclosure, since lateral walls **320** of the cooling channel **300** protrude downward from the floor surface **260** of the module housing **200** and an opened lower part of the cooling channel **300** is coupled with the channel cover **330** such that the cooling channel **300** is closed and sealed, the cooling channel **300** is formed outside the module housing **200** and thus a risk in operation of the cell stack **100** due to a leakage of coolant in the cooling channel **300** can be effectively reduced.

(73) In addition, all of the outer wall **210** and the floor surface **260** of the module housing **200** and the lateral wall **320** of the cooling channel **300** are integrally formed through the cast process, so that a water leakage possible region does not exist, and further, the cooling channel **300** is provided in the lower portion of the floor surface **260** of the module housing **200**, that is, the outside of the internal space of the module housing **200**, so that even if the coolant unintentionally leaks from the cooling channel **300**, it is possible to prevent the coolant from flowing into the internal space of the module housing **200**, in which the cell stack **100** is present.

(74) As a result, in the exemplary embodiment of the present disclosure, the plurality of cell stacks **100** is inserted to simplify an assembling process and components and effectively satisfy high power demanded, it is possible to effectively cool the plurality of cell stacks **100** through the cooling channel **300**, and further, it is possible to effectively protect the plurality of cell stacks **100** from the coolant leakage phenomenon in the cooling channel **300**.

(75) Meanwhile, FIG. **5** illustrates a figure in which a plurality of battery modules according to an exemplary embodiment of the present disclosure are provided and are interconnected. That is, FIG. **5** illustrates a figure in which the large modules of a battery are coupled to each other to form a large pack.

(76) As illustrated in FIG. **5**, the battery module according to an exemplary embodiment of the present disclosure may further include a coupling part **400** provided in the module housing **200** and coupled to the adjacent module housing **1001**.

(77) In the module housing **200** of the present invention the plurality of receiving parts **220** are provided to provide the plurality of cell stacks **100**, thereby effectively achieving high output. In some cases, required power required by an electrical energy consuming device may exceed an output that can be provided by the battery module **1000** according to the exemplary embodiment of the present invention.

(78) The battery modules **1000** may be coupled to each other to meet the required power, thereby making it possible to realize a large pack structure, and FIG. **5** illustrates a figure in which the coupling parts **400** between the corresponding module housing **200** and the adjacent module housing **1001** are coupled to each other.

(79) The coupling part **400** may be provided in various types and shapes, and FIG. **5** illustrates fastening parts **410** fastened to each other through the fastening member, guide parts **420** aligning positions of the respective fastening parts **410** of the corresponding battery module and the adjacent battery module, and connection parts **430**, which are connection passages of a bus bar **436** for electrical connection with the adjacent module housing **1001** according to an exemplary embodiment of the present invention.

(80) Additionally, in FIG. **6**, a coolant line **360** coupled to the plurality of module housings **200** is illustrated. As shown in FIG. **6**, the battery module **1000** according to the exemplary embodiment

of the present invention may further include a coolant line that is connected together with each cooling channel of neighboring module housings **200**.

(81) The coolant line **360** is provided in the form of a pipe or a tube through which coolant flows, and may supply the coolant to the cooling channel **300** that is provided below the module housing **200** or receive the coolant discharged from the cooling channel **300**. The cooling channel **300** connected to the coolant line **360** may cool the plurality of receiving parts **240** that are disposed above while the coolant flows through the cooling channel **300**.

(82) The coolant line **360** may be connected to the cooling channel of the corresponding module housing **200** and cooling channels **300** of neighboring module housings **200**. Thus, even when the battery module **1000** according to the exemplary embodiment of the present invention is provided as a large pack in which a plurality of battery modules **1000** are coupled to each other, the respective cooling channels **300** of the plurality of module housings **200** can be cooled through one coolant line **360**.

(83) The coolant line **360** may be connected with the respective cooling channel **300** of the plurality of module housings **200** through various methods. The coolant line **360** may be a serial type in which coolant is supplied to one cooling channel **300** and coolant discharged from the cooling channel **300** is supplied to the adjacent cooling channel **300**, and in one or more embodiments the coolant line **360** may be a parallel type in which any one of the coolant lines **360** supplies the coolant to the plurality of cooling channels **300** and the coolant discharged from the plurality of cooling channels **300** flows in the other coolant line **360**.

(84) Additionally, as shown in FIG. 6, in an exemplary embodiment of the present disclosure, the module housing **200** is coupled to the neighboring module housing **200** in a second direction Y that is perpendicular to the first direction X, and the coolant line **360** extends in the second direction Y, and may include a plurality of port connection holes **370** that are disposed apart from each other along a length direction and coupled to the cooling channel **300**.

(85) Since the module housing **200** is provided with a plurality of cell stacks **100**, each in which a plurality of unit cells **110** are aligned, the module housing **200** may have a rectangular shape that extends in the first direction X in which the unit cells **110** are aligned, and the module housing **200** may include a coupling part **400** so as to be coupled with the neighboring module housing **200** in the second direction Y.

(86) In addition, the coolant line **360** may have the plurality of port connection holes **370** that extend in the second direction Y and are disposed apart from each other so as to be connected to the respective cooling channels **300** of the plurality of module housings **200** that are aligned in the second direction Y as described above. In the large pack, the respective port connection holes **370** may be connected with cooling channels **300** of different module housings **200**.

(87) In FIG. 6, the coolant line **360** provided with the plurality of port connection holes **370** is illustrated, and FIG. 7 illustrates that different port connection holes **370** are connected to connection ports **325** that are respectively provided in the cooling channels **300**.

(88) One coolant line **360** extends in the second direction Y and is connected with a plurality of cooling channels **300** that are aligned in the second direction Y. That is, the coolant line **360** according to the exemplary embodiment of the present invention has a parallel form in which coolant is supplied to the plurality of cooling channels **300** or coolant discharged from the plurality of cooling channels **300** is recovered.

(89) That is, in the exemplary embodiment of the present invention, the coolant line **360** extends in the second direction Y and thus simultaneously connected to the respective cooling channels **300** of the plurality of module housings **200** such that the coolant can be supplied to or recovered from the plurality of cooling channels **300**, thereby improving structural safety and at the same time improving cooling efficiency.

(90) Additionally, as illustrated in FIG. 5, in the battery module **1000** according to an exemplary embodiment of the present disclosure, the coupling parts **400** may be provided on a first wall **211**

and a second wall **212** positioned in the second direction Y among the outer wall **210** of the module housing **200**, and the coupling part **400** provided on the second wall **212** of the module housing **200** may be coupled to the coupling part **400** provided on the first wall **211** of the adjacent module housing **1001**.

(91) The coupling parts **400** may be disposed in the module housing **200**, and as shown in FIG. 5, may be disposed on the outer wall **210** of the module housing **200**. The coupling parts **400** may be respectively provided in every two sides that face each other among four sides of the outer wall **210** such that the plurality of battery modules can be coupled to each other.

(92) In one or more embodiments, in the battery module **1000** according to an exemplary embodiment of the present disclosure, since the plurality of cell stacks **100** are inserted therein and the cell stacks **100** include the plurality of unit cells **110** aligned in the first direction X, the module housing **200** may have a cross section of a rectangular shape having a longer length in the first direction X.

(93) Accordingly, even when the plurality of module housings **200** are aligned in one line or coupled to each other through the coupling parts **400**, the coupling parts **400** may be disposed on the first wall **211** and the second wall **212** positioned in the second direction Y among the outer wall **210** of the module housing **200** so that an entire length of the plurality of module housings **200** may be reduced. However, a cross-section shape of the module housing **200** or a location of the coupling part **400** on the outer wall **210** may not be limited to the above-stated description.

(94) Accordingly, the coupling part **400** disposed on the first wall **211** of any one of the module housings **200** may be coupled to the coupling part **400** disposed on the second wall **212** of the other of the module housings facing the first wall **211**, and the coupling part **400** disposed on the second wall **212** of any one of the module housings **200** may be coupled to the coupling part **400** disposed on the first wall **211** of the other of the module housings **1001** facing the second wall **212**.

(95) Additionally, the coupling part **400** disposed in the first wall **211** in the outer wall **210** of the module housing **200** is inserted into the coupling part **400** of the neighboring module housing **1001** such that the corresponding module housing **200** and the neighboring module housing **1001** can be coupled to each other. For example, although it is not illustrated in FIG. 5, a fastening part **410**, a guide pin of a guide part **420**, and a tunnel insertion part of a connection part **430** may be disposed in the first wall **211**.

(96) In addition, the coupling part **400** disposed in the second wall **212** may be inserted into the coupling part **400** of the neighboring module housing **1001** such that the corresponding module housing **200** and the adjacent module housing **1001** may be coupled to each other. For example, as shown in FIG. 5, a fastening part **410**, a guide pin of a guide part **420**, and a connection tunnel of a connection part **430** may be disposed in the second wall **212**. However, an insertion relationship and each constituent element of the coupling parts **400** disposed in the first wall **211** and the second wall **212**, respectively, are not limited thereto.

(97) FIG. 12 illustrates a figure in which a plurality of battery modules according to another exemplary embodiment of the present disclosure are provided and are interconnected. That is, FIG. 12 illustrates a figure in which the battery modules are coupled to each other to form a large pack (e.g., a battery pack).

(98) As shown in FIG. 12, the coupling parts **400** are formed on the upper surface (or module cover) and the bottom surface of the battery module, and the coupling parts **400** between the battery modules adjacent to each other are coupled to each other. Accordingly, the plurality of battery modules may be stacked in the vertical direction (directions perpendicular to the first direction X and the second direction Y) through the coupling parts **400**.

(99) For example, the connection part **430** disposed on the upper surface of the battery module **1000** may be inserted into the connection part **430** disposed on the bottom surface of the adjacent battery module **1001**. In addition, the connection parts **430** may be connection passages of the bus bar for electrical connection with the adjacent battery modules.

(100) Additionally, as shown in FIG. 6, in the battery module **1000** according to an exemplary embodiment of the present disclosure, the coolant line **360** includes an inflow line **362** through which coolant is supplied to the cooling channel **300** and an outflow line **364** through which coolant is supplied from the cooling channel **300**, and the inflow line **372** is connected to one side of the cooling channel **300** in the first direction X and the outflow line **364** is connected to the other side of the cooling channel **300** in the first direction X.

(101) The coolant line **360** may be formed of the inflow line **362** and the outflow line **362**, and the inflow line **362** transmits coolant supplied to a water source to the cooling channel **300** and the outflow line **362** transmits coolant discharged from the cooling channel **300** back to the water source.

(102) The water source stores or supplies coolant, and may be provided in various types and methods, and a cooling system may be provided to re-cool the coolant recovered from the cooling channel **300**. As shown in FIG. 6, the inflow line **362** and the outflow line **364** may be extended in the second direction Y, and each may be connected to the entire cooling channels **300**.

(103) As shown in FIG. 5 and FIG. 6, in one exemplary embodiment of the present disclosure, the plurality of module housings **200** may be aligned along the second direction Y, and the coupling part **400** may be disposed in the first wall **211** and the second wall **212** of the second direction Y among the outer walls **210** of the module housing **200**.

(104) That is, when the plurality of module housing **200** are coupled to each other, each module housing **200** may be coupled with a module housing **1001** of which first and second walls **211** and **212** of the respective module housings are neighbored with each other, and accordingly, the coolant line **260** may be connected to the lateral wall **320** that is disposed on the first direction X of the cooling channel **300**.

(105) In one embodiment, the inflow line **362** may be connected on one lateral wall disposed on the first direction X among lateral walls **320** of the cooling channel **300**, and the outflow line **364** may be connected on the other lateral wall, that is, the opposite lateral wall disposed in the first direction X among the lateral walls of the cooling channel **300**.

(106) In the cooling channel **300**, the inflow line **362** and the outflow line **362** are disposed opposite to each other, and accordingly, in one exemplary embodiment of the present disclosure, the coolant can flow along the first direction X without consuming additional power in the cooling channel **300**.

(107) In addition, since the plurality of cooling channels **300** receive the coolant in a parallel manner, the plurality of cooling channels **300** substantially receive the cooling water having the same water temperature, thereby improving cooling performance.

(108) Meanwhile, FIG. 8 illustrates the connection portion **325** where the port connection hole **370** is engaged. In the drawing, the port connection hole **370** shown in FIG. 7 is omitted. In an exemplary embodiment of the present disclosure, at least one of the plurality of port connection holes **370** may have a different diameter from the rest.

(109) In one exemplary embodiment of the present disclosure, the coolant line **360** is extended in the second direction Y and enables supplying coolant to the plurality of cooling channels **300** that are aligned in the second direction Y.

(110) However, the number of receiving parts **240** formed in the module housing **200** may be different as desired as described above, and when each of the plurality of module housings **200** that are coupled to each other has a different number of receiving parts **240**, the amount of coolant required for each module housing **200** may be different from one another.

(111) In one or more embodiments, the amount of coolant supplied to the plurality of cooling channels **300** connected to one coolant line **360** may be different from each other depending on a distance from a water source.

(112) Accordingly, in the exemplary embodiment of the present invention, at least one of the plurality of port connection holes **370** provided in the coolant line **360** is different in diameter from

the rest so as to set a flow amount of coolant differently for each cooling channel **300**.

(113) The port connection hole **370** may be provided in a form that can be coupled to or separated from the coolant line **360**, and accordingly, when a diameter of one port connection hole **370** is changed, the corresponding port connection hole **370** can be removed and a port connection hole **370** having a different diameter may be coupled to the corresponding location to thereby adjust a diameter.

(114) The connection port **325** shown in FIG. **8** may be integrally formed with the cooling channel **300**, or may be manufactured as a separate injection product and coupled to an opening of the cooling channel **300**. The connection port **325** may be provided with a predetermined diameter range so that a plurality of port connection holes **370** of which diameters are included in the range can be coupled to the connection port **325**, or may be exchangeable with another connection port **325** having a diameter that corresponding to a diameter of the corresponding port connection hole **370**.

(115) Additionally, referring back to FIG. **1** and FIG. **2**, in the battery module **1000** according to an exemplary embodiment of the present disclosure, the module housing **200** may further include the separation wall **230** that extends in the first direction X, and partitions the inner space surrounded by the outer wall **210** to contribute to form the plurality of receiving parts **220**, and the separation wall **230** may configure a portion of the fixed walls **250** of the two receiving parts **220** disposed at both sides along the second direction Y, and may be in contact with the side surfaces of the cell stack **100** inserted into each of the two receiving parts **220**.

(116) The side surfaces refer to both side surfaces extending in the first direction X among the side surfaces of the cell stack, and as described above, since the cell stack **100** according to the present invention does not include the separate module frame, the side surfaces may correspond to the insulation member **112** around (or surrounding) the side surfaces of the plurality of unit cells **110**.

(117) The separation wall **230** may be provided to protrude upwardly from a floor surface **260** of the module housing **200**, and may be provided to divide the inner space of the module housing **200** while extending along the first direction X. That is, the separation wall **230** may correspond to a portion of the fixed wall **250** around (or surrounding) the receiving part **220**, that is, one surface thereof.

(118) Referring to FIGS. **1** and **2**, the receiving parts **220** are formed at both sides of the separation wall **230**, and the separation wall **230** becomes the fixed wall **250** for the two receiving parts **220** formed at both sides thereof.

(119) Referring to FIG. **2**, the separation wall **230** faces the side surfaces of the cell stack **100** inserted into the receiving part **220**, and accordingly, the separation wall **230** corresponding to a portion of the fixed wall **250** is in direct contact with at least a portion of the side surfaces of the cell stack **100** inserted into the receiving part **220** to thereby support the cell stack **100** in the second direction Y.

(120) Additionally, in FIG. **2**, a part of the plurality of end walls **240** is provided at a distance from the outer wall **210** of the module housing **200**, and FIG. **9** shows the end wall **240** spaced by a distance from the outer wall **210**, viewed from the top side.

(121) In an exemplary embodiment of the present disclosure, the end wall **240** among the end walls **240**, which is disposed so that one surface faces the outer wall **210** of the module housing **200**, may be spaced apart from the outer wall **210** in the first direction X and form the first impact absorption space **215** between the end wall **240** and the outer wall **210**.

(122) In an exemplary embodiment of the present disclosure, the plurality of end walls **240** may be provided as illustrated in FIGS. **1** and **2**, the end wall **240** facing the outer wall **210** among the plurality of end walls **240** may be spaced apart from the facing outer wall **210** of the module housing **200** in the first direction X and form the first impact absorption space **215** between the end wall **240** and the outer wall **210** as illustrated in FIG. **2** and FIG. **9**.

(123) FIG. **9** illustrates the end wall **240** among the end walls **240** facing the outer wall **210** of the

module housing **200** configuring the fixed wall **250** of the receiving part **220**, and illustrates the first impact absorption space **215** formed between the end wall **240** and the outer wall **210**.

(124) The module housing **200** needs to safely protect the cell stack **100** inserted into the receiving part **220** against the impact transferred from the outside, and in an exemplary embodiment of the present among the end walls **240**, the end wall **240**, which is in direct contact with the end surface of the cell stack **100** and supports and presses the cell stack **100**, is spaced apart from the outer wall **210**, thereby preventing the impact transferred to the outer wall **210** from being directly transferred to the end wall **240**.

(125) Further, the safety of the battery can be improved because the impact transmitted from outside the module housing **200** by the first impact absorption space **215** is transmitted to the end wall **240** and the cell stack **100** in a reduced state.

(126) Further, it is important to appropriately cool the unit cell **110** heating during use process, and the first impact absorption space **215** itself may advantageously serve as a heat radiating space, in which heat of the cell stack **100** is dispersed.

(127) Additionally, in an exemplary embodiment of the present disclosure, as illustrated in FIGS. **1** and **2**, the plurality of receiving parts **220** is disposed in the internal space of the module housing **200** in the first direction X, and in two receiving parts **220** adjacent in the first direction X, the end walls **240** disposed on surfaces facing in the first direction X are spaced apart from each other to form the second impact absorption space **216** between the end walls **240**.

(128) In FIG. **1**, the module housing **200** where four receiving parts **220** are formed depending on the exemplary embodiment of the present invention is illustrated, and every two receiving parts **220** are aligned along the first direction X. However, the number of receiving parts **220** aligned along the first direction X may be different in one or more other embodiments.

(129) In each of the two receiving parts **220** adjacent to each other in the first direction X, one surface, in which the fixed wall **250** of one receiving part **220** faces the fixed wall **250** of the other receiving part **220**, the two receiving parts **220** have different end walls **240** facing each other. That is, the receiving parts **220** arranged in the first direction X do not share the end wall **240**.

(130) Referring to FIG. **2**, it is illustrated the case where in the two receiving parts **220** arranged in the first direction X, the end walls **240** facing each other are spaced apart from each other, and the second impact absorption space **216** is formed between the end walls **240**.

(131) The second impact absorption space **216** protects the cell stack **100** inserted into the corresponding receiving part **220** from the impact transferred from the outside of the receiving part **220**, like the first impact absorption space **215**. For example, the first impact absorption space **215** may suppress the impact transferred from the outer wall **210** of the module housing **200** from being transferred to the internal space of the module housing **200**, and the second impact absorption space **216** may suppress the impact transferred to any one receiving part **220** from being transferred to the other receiving part **220** adjacent in the first direction X.

(132) Additionally, FIG. **9** illustrates that the end support **120** is disposed at an outer side of the outermost cell of the cell stack **100**, and FIG. **11** shows an end surface of the end support **120**.

(133) As illustrated in FIGS. **9** and **11**, in the battery module **1000** according to an exemplary embodiment of the present disclosure, the cell stack **100** may further include one pair of end supports **120**, which is disposed at both end portions in the first direction X and of which an outer surface corresponds to the end surface.

(134) In an exemplary embodiment of the present disclosure, the plurality of unit cells **110** is provided in the form of which at least the lateral surface is surrounded by the insulation member **112**, and the end supports **120** may be disposed in the form in which the inner surface of each of the end supports **120** is in surface contact with the insulation member **112**, at both ends of the cell stack **100** in the first direction X. However, a positional relationship between the insulation member **112** and the end support **120** are not essentially limited thereto.

(135) The end supports **120** are disposed at both ends of the cell stack **100** in the first direction X,

and the outer surfaces of the end supports **120** may correspond to the end surfaces. The end support **120** may serve to absorb impact between the end wall **240** and the plurality of unit cells **110**, and may serve to uniformly transfer pressing force of the end wall **240** to the outermost cell among the plurality of unit cells **110**.

(136) The outermost cell means the unit cell **100** positioned at the outermost side in the first direction X among the plurality of unit cells **110** configuring the cell stack **100**, and in an exemplary embodiment of the present disclosure, the outermost cell is disposed at each of both ends in the first direction X among the plurality of unit cells **110**.

(137) Even though the end wall **240** does not press the end support **120** with the entire surface thereof because the end wall **240** has the bent shape and the like, the end support **120** may press the insulation member **112** and the outer surface of the outermost cell with the entire surface thereof.

(138) Additionally, FIG. **9** illustrates the end wall **240**, which is bent so that the center portion is further from the end surface, and FIG. **10** illustrates the inner surface looking at the end surface of the cell stack **100** in the bent end wall **240**.

(139) As shown in FIGS. **9** and **10**, in the battery module according to an exemplary embodiment of the present disclosure, the end wall **240** is bent to the outside so that the center portion of the end wall **240** is further from the facing end surface, so that a swelling space **217** may be formed between the end wall **240** and the end surface.

(140) The end wall **240** may be formed in the shape bent so that the center portion of the end wall **240** is further from the end surface that faces in the cell stack **100** inserted into the receiving part **220**. Only the center portion may be concavely indented based in the second direction Y and the height direction, but the end wall **240** may be provided in the form bent so that the cross-section of the end wall **240** is curved, as illustrated in FIG. **9**.

(141) The end wall **240** has the bent shape, so that a space is formed at least the center portion between the end wall **240** and the end surface of the cell stack **100**, and the corresponding space corresponds to the swelling space **217** in an exemplary embodiment of the present disclosure.

(142) In the unit cell **110** of the cell stack **100**, a swelling phenomenon, in which gas is generated from the internal electrode assembly and is expanded, may be generated according to deterioration of durability by the use and a peripheral situation, and the implementation of the structure, which is capable of appropriately treating the swelling, is beneficial in the structure, in which the plurality of unit cells **110** is arranged.

(143) For example, when swelling occurs in any one of unit cells **110**, other unit cells **110** of the cell stack **100** that includes the corresponding unit cell **110** may possibly experience the swelling, and when the swelling occurs in one unit cell **110** among the entire unit cells **110** and thus a thickness is increased, the entire length of the cell stack **110** may be greatly affected. Further, the length change of the cell stack **100** may affect the end wall **240** that presses the cell stack **100** in the first direction X such that a damage and the like may be caused.

(144) When the swelling phenomenon occurs, the unit cells **110** have a large amount of expansion of the central portion on the side surface positioned in the first direction X due to structural characteristics thereof, and accordingly, in an exemplary embodiment of the present disclosure, the swelling space **217** is formed between the end wall **240** and the end surface so as to accommodate a volume expansion of the cell stack **100** due to the swelling when the swelling phenomenon of the cell stack **100** occurs.

(145) Additionally, as described above, the cell stack **100** may be pressed or pressurized in the first direction X in terms of efficiency such as energy density and the like, and in an exemplary embodiment of the present invention, even though the central portion of the end wall **240** pressurizing the end surface is bent to be recessed, since at least the both end sides of the end wall **240** maintain a pressed or pressurized state of the end surface, the cell stack **100** is advantageously operated.

(146) Furthermore, as shown in FIG. **9** and FIG. **11**, the end surface may be concavely indented

such that a center portion of the end surface may be away from the facing end wall **240**. That is, the end wall **240** may have a shape in which a center portion of the end surface is concave.

(147) In an embodiment in which the end support **120** is provided, the end surface corresponding to the outer surface of the end support **120** may have the shape, in which the center portion of the end surface is indented, so that a space is formed in at least the center portion between the end surface and the end wall **240** similar to the end wall **240** having the bent shape, and thus the swelling space **217** may be formed in at least the center portion between the end support **120** and the end wall **240**.

(148) For example, if swelling occurs in at least one of the plurality of unit cells **110** and thus a center portion of the unit cell **110** is expanded, a center portion of the end support **120** is pressed toward the end wall **240** due to the expansion of the center portion of the plurality of unit cells **110**. However, the center portion of the end surface of the end support **120** is inwardly concave such that even when the center portion of the end support **120** is pressed to the outside or deformed, deformation or damage to the end wall **240** can be suppressed or prevented by the swelling space **217** formed between the end support **120** and the end wall **240**.

(149) Additionally, as shown in FIG. 2 and FIG. 9, a plurality of first ribs **242** may be formed in the end wall **240** according to the exemplary embodiment of the present invention. Particularly, the end wall **240** may include the plurality of first ribs **242** on the outer surface based on the first direction X.

(150) In one or more embodiments, the end wall **240** is strong against impact from the outside while pressing the end surface of the cell stack **100**, and further, even when the swelling space **217** is formed, the end wall **240** has mechanical strength, by which the end wall **240** is prevented from being damaged.

(151) Accordingly, in an exemplary embodiment of the present disclosure, as illustrated in FIGS. 2 and 9, the plurality of first ribs **242** may be provided in the outer surface of the end wall **240**, that is, one surface facing the outer wall **210** or a surface opposite to the cell stack **100**.

(152) The first rib **242** is formed on the outer surface of the end wall **240** for protecting the cell stack **100**. The outer surface of the end wall **240** means a surface facing the opposite side of the end support **120**. The first rib **242** may be separately manufactured and be coupled to the end wall **240**, and the first rib **242** may be integrally formed with the end wall **240** by a cast process.

(153) As illustrated in FIGS. 2 and 9, the plurality of first ribs **242** may be extended in the height direction of the end wall **240**, and may be spaced apart from each other in the second direction Y.

(154) The first rib **242** may be provided in the form extended in the height direction of the end wall **240**, that is, may be extended toward the top side from the bottom side **260** of the module housing **200**. Accordingly, the first rib **242** may effectively improve strength of the end wall **240** and may be integrally formed with the end wall **240** in a cast process using an upper mold and a lower mold.

(155) Further, the plurality of first ribs **242** is spaced apart from each other in the second direction Y, thereby achieving uniformly and stably improving strength for the entire end wall **240**. FIG. 9 illustrates a cross-section of the plurality of first ribs **242** spaced apart from each other in the second direction Y.

(156) Additionally, FIG. 11 illustrates the end support **120** in which the plurality of second ribs **122** is formed on the end surface. As shown in FIG. 11, in an exemplary embodiment of the present disclosure, the end support **120** may include the plurality of second ribs **122** that protrude toward the end wall **240** in the end surface.

(157) Swelling force transferred from the plurality of unit cells **110** is applied to the end support **120** at the time of the generation of swelling and the end support **120** responds to expansion of the unit cells **110**, and therefore in one or more embodiments the end support **120** is strong against transformation and damage due to the swelling phenomenon.

(158) Accordingly, the second rib **122** is formed on the end surface of the end support **120** to improve strength of the end support **120**. That is, an inner surface of the end support **120**, that is, the surface opposite to the end surface, is in surface contact with the outermost cell of the cell stack

100 or the insulation member **112** to uniformly secure pressing performance, and the second ribs **122** are formed on the end surface of the end support **120**.

(159) Further, as illustrated in FIG. 5, in an exemplary embodiment of the present disclosure, the second ribs **122** may be spaced apart from each other in the second direction Y and the height direction of the end support **120** so as to form a lattice shape.

(160) Referring to FIG. 11, in an exemplary embodiment of the present disclosure, the second ribs **122** may be formed to approximately cross the entirety of the end surface in the extension direction, and some of the plurality of second ribs **122** are extended in the second direction Y and the remaining second ribs **122** are extended in the height direction of the end support **120**, so that the plurality of second ribs **122** may be disposed to form a lattice form.

(161) That is, the plurality of second ribs **122** may be disposed to be spaced apart from each other in the second direction Y and the height direction of the end support **120** to form a lattice shape, and accordingly, robustness of the end support **120** can be effectively improved.

(162) That is, in the end support **120**, quadrangular recesses may be approximately disposed in the lattice shape on the end surface, and the second rib **122** may be separately manufactured and be coupled to the end surface of the end support **120** or be integrally formed with the end support **120** when the end support **120** is manufactured.

(163) Additionally, in an exemplary embodiment of the present disclosure, the fixed wall **250** of any one receiving part **220** may be defined to include the separation wall **230**, one pair of end walls **240**, and a part of the outer wall **210**, and the separation wall **230** and the end walls **240** may be integrally formed through a cast process or the like.

(164) Further, as illustrated in FIG. 2, in an exemplary embodiment of the present disclosure, one surface among the four surfaces of the fixed wall **250** corresponds to the separation wall **230**, two other surfaces correspond to the end walls, respectively, and one remaining surface may be formed of the outer wall **210** of the module housing **200**.

(165) In the battery module **1000** according to an exemplary embodiment of the present disclosure, the end walls **240**, the separation wall **230**, and the outer wall **210** may be integrally formed with the floor surface **260** of the module housing **200** by a cast process.

(166) That is, in an exemplary embodiment of the present disclosure, the end walls **240** and the separation walls **230** may be integrally formed with the module housing **200**, and when a mold is manufacturing for the cast process, intaglio (i.e., an engraving) of the end walls **240** and the separation wall **230** may be integrally formed in the mold.

(167) Further, in an exemplary embodiment of the present disclosure, the end walls **240** and the separation wall **230** may also be integrally formed with the outer wall **210** of the module housing **200**. In this case, in the module housing **200**, all of the outer wall **210**, the separation wall **230**, the end walls **240**, and the floor surface **260** may be integrally formed.

(168) As described, in the module housing **200** to which the end wall **240** and the separation wall **230** are integrally formed, an additional manufacturing process for including the end wall **240** and the separation wall **230** are components can be omitted, and as previously described, even when a module frame is omitted by the end wall **240** and the separation wall **230**, the cell stack **100** can be stably fixed while the plurality of unit cells **110** are in a pressed state in the receiving parts **220**.

(169) While this invention has been described in connection with what is presently considered to be practical exemplary embodiments, it is to be understood that the invention is not limited to the disclosed embodiments, but, on the contrary, is intended to cover various modifications and equivalent arrangements included within the spirit and scope of the appended claims.

(170) TABLE-US-00001 Description of symbols 100: cell stack 110: unit cell 120: end support 122: second rib 200: module housing 210: outer wall of module housing 211: first wall 212: second wall 215: first impact absorption space 216: second impact absorption space 220: receiving part 230: separation wall 240: end wall 242: first rib 250: fixed wall 260: floor surface of module housing 300: cooling channel 310: flowing space 320: lateral wall of cooling channel

325: connection port 330: channel cover 350: guide protrusion 360: coolant line 362: inflow line
364: outflow line 370: port connection hole 400: coupling part 410: fastening part 420: guide
part 430: connection part 1000: battery module

Claims

1. A battery module comprising: a first module; a second module adjacent to the first module in a first direction and coupled to the first module, wherein each of the first module and the second module comprises: a plurality of cell stacks; a module housing; and a plurality of receiving parts in the module housing, the plurality of receiving parts being configured to accommodate the plurality of cell stacks; and a coupling part coupling the module housing of the first module to the module housing of the second module, wherein each of the plurality of receiving parts comprises a fixed wall, wherein the module housing of the first module is coupled to the module housing of the second module in a first direction, wherein a cooling channel for a coolant to flow to cool the plurality of receiving parts and the plurality of cell stacks is below a floor surface of the module housing, wherein the battery module further comprises a cooling plate coupled to the floor surface of the module housing, wherein the cooling channel is in the cooling plate, and a coolant line connected to the cooling channel of the module housing of each of the first and second modules, wherein the coolant line extends in the first direction and comprises a plurality of port connection holes spaced from each other along a length direction of the coolant line and coupled to the cooling channel of each of the first and second modules, wherein a plurality of guide protrusions extends on a lower surface of the floor surface in a second direction perpendicular to the first direction, the plurality of guide protrusions being spaced apart from each other in the first direction, and wherein lengths of the plurality of guide protrusions vary in the first direction.
2. The battery module of claim 1, wherein the cooling channel comprises at least one lateral wall that protrudes downward and surrounds the floor surface, the at least one lateral wall forms the cooling channel, and wherein each of the first module and the second module further comprises a channel cover coupled to lower ends of the at least one lateral wall to close and seal the cooling channel.
3. The battery module of claim 2, wherein the at least one lateral wall of the cooling channel is integral with the floor surface.
4. The battery module of claim 1, wherein the coupling part comprises a first coupling part in a first wall of the module housing of the first module and a second coupling part in a second wall of the module housing of the second module, wherein the first wall is spaced from the second wall in the first direction.
5. The battery module of claim 1, wherein the coolant line comprises: an inflow line configured to supply coolant to the cooling channel; and an outflow line configured to discharge the coolant from the cooling channel, wherein the inflow line is connected to one side of the cooling channel of each of the first modules and the second module, wherein the outflow line is connected to another side of the cooling channel of each of the first module and the second module, and wherein the one side and the another side of the cooling channel are at opposite sides along a second direction perpendicular to the first direction.
6. The battery module of claim 1, wherein at least one of the plurality of port connection holes has a different diameter than at least one other port connection hole of the plurality of port connection holes.
7. The battery module of claim 1, wherein the module housing of each of the first module and the second module further comprises a separation wall that extends in a second direction perpendicular to the first direction and partitions an inner space surrounded by an outer wall of the module housing to form the plurality of receiving parts, and wherein the separation wall forms a part of the fixed wall of each of the plurality of receiving parts at sides along the first direction, the separation

wall contacts side surfaces of a pair of cell stacks in respective receiving parts of the plurality of receiving parts.

8. The battery module of claim 7, wherein the fixed wall comprises a pair of end walls at opposite ends of each of the receiving parts in the second direction, and wherein an end wall of the pair of end walls facing the outer wall of the module housing is spaced apart from the outer wall along the second direction and forms a first impact absorption space between the end wall and the outer wall.

9. The battery module of claim 8, wherein the plurality of receiving parts comprises two receiving parts adjacent to each other along the second direction, and wherein end walls of the two receiving parts facing each other in the second direction are spaced apart from each other to form a second impact absorption space between the end walls.

10. The battery module of claim 8, wherein each cell stack of the plurality of cell stacks comprises a pair of end supports at opposite end portions in the second direction, the pair of end supports having outer surfaces corresponding to respective end surfaces of a corresponding cell stack accommodated in each of the receiving parts.

11. The battery module of claim 10, wherein the end walls are bent outwardly such that central portions of the end walls are spaced from the end surfaces, and wherein the end surfaces are recessed inwardly such that central portions of the end surfaces are spaced from the end walls.

12. The battery module of claim 11, wherein at least one end wall of the end walls comprises a plurality of first ribs that protrude in the second direction from an outer surface, the plurality of first ribs spaced from each other in the first direction and extend in a third direction perpendicular to each of the first direction and the second direction.

13. The battery module of claim 12, wherein at least one end support of the pair of end supports comprises a plurality of second ribs protruding toward the at least one end wall from the end surface and spaced from each other in the first direction and the third direction.

14. The battery module of claim 13, wherein the plurality of second ribs has a lattice structure.
